

Preparation for WB Stakeholder Consultation on Lessons Learned and the Way Forward for the Housing Reconstruction

HRRP Office, 19 July 2018

Participants: Kam for Sud, USAID, Medair, Helvetas, Build Up Nepal, Habitat for Humanity Nepal, Nepal Nazareth Society, CRS, UNRCO/CFP, Mott MacDonald/Purnima, TI Nepal, and UNDP.

Introduction

On 24 July the World Bank is holding a stakeholder consultation on 'Lessons Learning and Way Forward for the Housing Reconstruction Programme'. The objective of the consultation is to *"understand the concerns and issues of the relevant stakeholders and their views on how to improve and expedite the reconstruction activities. These consultations will assist in preparing for the upcoming Mid Term Review (MTR) of Nepal Earthquake Housing Reconstruction Project (EHRP). The MTR provides stakeholders with the opportunity to review progress, draw learning and, if required, make necessary adjustments in implementation arrangements"*.

In preparation for this, HRRP held a meeting with partners on 19 July to agree the points that HRRP should raise at the stakeholder consultation.

Groupwork

The session started with groupwork. The participants split into four groups each considering one of the following questions, the points agreed by the groups are included below the questions:

1. What are the opportunities in the housing reconstruction?
 - a. Awareness among public
 - b. Utilization of lessons learnt on earthquake by other non- affected districts
 - c. Introduction of alternative and more effective methods of construction
 - d. Labour shortage creating space for marginalised / vulnerable groups to work in construction sector
 - e. Review of land use policy
 - f. Building code enforcement and update with new technologies and local materials
 - g. Job creation (reducing rate of migration)
 - h. Promoting and developing local entrepreneurs
 - i. Gender power balancing through joint land ownership
 - j. More socio-technical assistance for the remaining reconstruction period
 - k. Decentralisation of construction materials
2. What are the challenges in the housing reconstruction?
 - a. Delays in tranche disbursement
 - b. Lack of monitoring mechanism for the engineers to make them more accountable.
 - c. Mismatch of building codes and locally available materials leading to delay in reconstruction
 - d. Inconsistent Government decision and information leading to confusion and delay in construction
 - e. Lack of vernacular housing designs
 - f. Engineers are not providing sufficient technical assistance to households they are just doing inspection
 - g. Households cannot access subsidised loans

- h. Not enough skilled masons available
 - i. Retrofitting grant process is not clear
 - j. Reconstruction grant is not enough to build a house
3. What has worked well in the housing reconstruction so far?
- a. Government regulations, policies, building code – first time that houses are being built with EQ resistant elements in many places
 - b. Mandatory inspection process
 - c. Development of technical guidelines, e.g. hybrid structures, timber and steel frame, corrections and exceptions, retrofitting, etc.
 - d. Socio-technical assistance
 - e. Support to vulnerable families (technical and social)
 - f. Coordination
4. What has not worked well in the reconstruction so far?
- a. Coordination – between donors and NRA, inter-ministerial
 - b. Relocation of families
 - c. Urban housing reconstruction – no consolidated effort in this area, needs a different mechanism to rural areas, housing reconstruction grant has very different impact due to much higher cost of construction
 - d. No institutional process to take policies, manuals, guidance documents, etc. to field level
 - e. NRA not given sufficient resources and authority
 - f. Too many committees / meetings with lots of discussion but no decisions



Two of the groups during the groupwork session.

HRRP Presentation

The presentation, available [here](#), covered the following:

- Reconstruction timeframe
- Strategic recovery objective 1 (from the PDRF) and progress in relation to this
- District and municipal view – collected by HRRP District Coordination Teams (DCTs) from district and municipal officials and Partner Organisations (POs)
- Shared initial results from a survey being conducted with NRA, Building DLPIU technical staff
- Shared overview of data collection exercise on capacity building activities for municipal and ward officials
- Presented need for additional support in 18 districts and for urban reconstruction
- Considered the urban housing reconstruction and rural housing reconstruction sector plans from the PDRF
- Presented a draft list of points for HRRP to bring to the WB stakeholder consultation

Discussion

Some of the points raised included:

- Relocation of families cannot just be about supporting purchase of a plot of land on which to build a house. Shared example of a woman in Dhading who has relocated after receiving the subsidy and purchasing land but she has lost all options for work / income generation. She used to have land where she could grow crops and keep livestock but she does not have space for that anymore.
- Suggested that could be really useful to deploy students of engineering, social sciences, etc. to support reconstruction efforts in the districts. All agreed but highlighted that effectiveness would be dependent on having an increased level of support for the NRA, Building DLPIU technical staff that they would work with.
- Need to include point on finance and potential debt crisis in list. USAID informed that there is a consultation with banks on 23 July and will be useful to understand their perspectives.
- All agreed that training / capacity building support for local authorities will be essential part of improving housing reconstruction. HRRP highlighted that focus needs to be on common approach that provides continuous support as to date the orientations on reconstruction have been one off, or different standards / scope, and coverage has been patchy.
- Points should include something about need to provide targeted support to vulnerable households. Even though this is covered by other points, need to make sure this is highlighted.
- Good to include something about having design guidelines for new / emerging construction technologies and materials. Recognising that updating the building code to include these is a big process, could be an option to have design guidelines published to accompany second catalogue of designs published by DUDBC. At the moment the catalogue just enables construction of one or two designs for these materials, but design guidelines could support with development of different designs following agreed design parameters and standards.
- Coordination at all levels is important and need to consider extension of HRRP as priority as well as potential for other initiatives to support coordination.
- Important to recognise the positives so far; getting the grant process established and disbursing more than 1 billion USD to date is a huge achievement, also getting all the policies developed has been an achievement. Need to build on this.
- It would be good to have more acknowledgement of the contribution of Partner Organisations (POs) so far and work on collaboration between POs and GoN. Gave example of Gujarat reconstruction where government worked very closely with CSOs.

-
- The group agreed to rephrase “move away from collection of GoN approved PO projects” as “adopt a collective and collaborative approach”
 - Need to consider how the learning from the reconstruction is retained institutionally. The National Disaster Management Authority (NDMA) is an obvious place for this, but also within ministries and departments, within POs, etc.
 - Participants were requested to share any reference documents, data, case studies, etc. that can be used to back up the points to be presented by HRRP during the consultation